the World Bank, Mr. George Woods, were concluded in exactly 12 minutes.'[31]

Mehta himself saw his stint at ICICI as a rewarding experience. He wrote, 'However, towards the end of my career—when 58 and when most people would retire or have to—it was a stroke of good fortune for me (through the good offices of Mr. George Woods and Mr. Black on one side and the courtesy of Dr. Ramaswami Mudaliar on the other) to have joined this Corporation. It has been a creative and rewarding experience—seeing industries being established and expanding, technical talents being developed, new products and processes coming into vogue. When I joined the Corporation, the number of projects assisted was about 62 and total gross sanctions about ₹18 crores; when I left, the total number of projects had come to 1339 and the total gross sanctions to ₹405 crores. The discipline, integrity, enthusiasm and harmony with which all those associated with ICICI have worked these years have been a source of satisfaction.'[32]

They were a happy team under Mehta's leadership. Under Mehta's benign leadership and Parekh's sound professionalism, ICICI acquired much prestige. Mehta would often say that he had never experienced such peace, happiness, and satisfaction elsewhere and the staff too enjoyed working as one big happy team. It was this team spirit which made ICICI's development possible. N. Vaghul, who later became the Chairman of ICICI, at a function to celebrate the birth centenary of Parekh said that while Mehta was the public face of ICICI, it was the quiet Parekh who was working behind the scenes, and a lot of the credit for ICICI becoming what it did should go to Parekh. Vaghul said that with Parekh's achievement in setting up HDFC, his contribution to ICICI was pushed into the background.[33]

Parekh in his tribute to Mehta on All India Radio on the latter's demise in April 1974 said, 'His last, and perhaps his fondest, love was ICICI, with which he was associated for the last 15 years of his life. He never tired of saying that these were among the happiest years of his life. It was during these long years that I had the privilege of working with him in ICICI. Having to work closely with him, day after day, we, in ICICI came under his spell. He captured the hearts of everyone, high and low, by his charm, his informality, his wit, his youthful spirit, his restlessness, his wide